

Couples Therapy Worksheets

A print-ready, session-by-session worksheet package based on the *Handbook of Couples Therapy* (Harway, Ed., 2005). Use **Print all worksheets** in the toolbar to print the full packet, or the **Print this worksheet** button on any sheet to print just that one. In the print dialog choose **Save as PDF** to export a PDF. Each worksheet starts on a fresh page.

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Couples Therapy Worksheets — Clinician's Guide (How to Use)

Based on: *Handbook of Couples Therapy*, edited by Michele Harway (John Wiley & Sons, 2005).

This worksheet series translates the clinical frameworks from the *Handbook of Couples Therapy* into a usable session-by-session toolkit. It integrates the book's three organizing perspectives — **developmental** (life-cycle stages), **theoretical** (CBCT, EFT, Narrative, Strategic/Solution-Focused, Object Relations, PAIRS, Bowen, Feminist/Contextual), and **situational** (illness, abuse, aggression, addiction, infidelity, divorce). Content paraphrased and reorganized for clinical use.

1. Who this is for

Licensed or supervised mental-health professionals (MFTs, psychologists, counselors, social workers) conducting conjoint couples therapy.

2. The arc of treatment at a glance

A typical course runs **12–20 sessions**; brief work compresses it, complex cases extend it.

Phase	Sessions	Core task	Worksheets
Phase 0 — Pre-work / Screening	Before or at Session 1	Screen for safety	01, Part B
Phase 1 — Assessment & Alliance	Sessions 1–3	Intake, individual histories, functional assessment, cycle mapping	01, 02, 10, 11, 12, 13
Phase 2 — Formulation & Goals	Session 3–4	Shared formulation, goals, treatment plan	03, 14
Phase 3 — De-escalation & Communication	Sessions 4–8	Interrupt the negative cycle; communication & listening skills	04
Phase 4 — Restructuring the bond	Sessions 8–14	Emotional restructuring, attachment, cognitive restructuring, problem-solving	05, 06
Phase 5 — Special issues (as indicated)	Interwoven	Infidelity, illness, addiction, aggression, etc.	07
Phase 6 — Consolidation & Termination	Final 2–3 sessions	Relapse prevention, rituals, ending	08
Ongoing	Every session	Session-rating, homework	15

3. How to use the worksheets with couples

1. **Lead with the alliance, not the forms.**
2. **Stay non-blaming and multidirectionally partial.**
3. **Assess before you intervene.**
4. **Screen for safety first.**
5. **Weave culture and context through everything.**
6. **Match the worksheet to the model you practice.** CBCT □ Worksheet 06; EFT □ Worksheet 05; Solution-Focused □ Worksheets 03 & 15.

Practical mechanics:

- Give each partner their **own copy** of individual-reflection worksheets.
- Use joint worksheets as a shared in-session artifact.

- Assign homework from Worksheet 15 every session.
- Keep completed worksheets in the clinical file for the termination review (Worksheet 08).

4. Session-by-session map

Session 1 □ Joint intake + alliance + safety screen + goals [01, 10, 12]
 Session 2 □ Individual history (Partner A) [02, 13]
 Session 3 □ Individual history (Partner B) [02, 13]
 Session 4 □ Feedback / formulation / goals / treatment plan [03, 11, 14]
 Sessions 5–6 □ Cycle de-escalation + communication skills [04]
 Sessions 7–8 □ Cognitive restructuring / problem solving [06]
 Sessions 9–12 □ Emotion & attachment restructuring, enactments [05]
 (as needed) □ Special-issue module(s) interwoven [07]
 Sessions 13–15 □ Deepen, generalize, caring behaviors [04/05/06]
 Final 2–3 □ Consolidation, relapse prevention, ending [08]
 Every session □ Tracking + homework [15]

5. Clinical notes & limitations

- These are **clinical tools, not a treatment manual or a substitute for training/supervision.**
 - **Safety overrides sequence.** If violence, addiction, or acute risk is identified, pause the standard arc and follow Worksheet 07.
 - Document informed consent and your no-secrets policy before the individual sessions (Worksheet 02).
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File Index

File	Contents
00 — Clinician Guide	This guide
01 — First Session: Intake & Alliance	Joint intake, relationship history, safety screen, presenting concerns, goals
02 — Individual History Sessions	Family of origin, attachment history, expectations, private safety check
03 — Formulation & Treatment Plan	Shared formulation, cycle map, miracle/scaling, goal-setting, treatment plan
04 — Communication & De-escalation	Satir styles, I-messages, speaker-listener, Love Knots, time-out plan
05 — Emotion & Attachment Restructuring	EFT: primary/secondary emotion, attachment needs, enactments, injury repair
06 — Cognitive Restructuring & Problem-Solving	CBCT: thought records, attributions, behavior exchange, caring days
07 — Special Issues Modules	Illness, sexual abuse, aggression, addiction, infidelity, spiritual, same-sex, socioeconomic, divorce
08 — Consolidation & Termination	Progress review, relapse prevention, sustaining rituals, ending
10 — Presenting Problems Checklist	Systematic checklist of all problem areas + functional analysis
11 — Comprehensive Assessment Battery	Multi-domain assessment: cycle, attachment, individual, Bowen, strengths, risk
12 — First-Session Goals Deep Dive	Step-by-step guide to the 9 goals of the first session
13 — Genogram & Family of Origin	Three-generation genogram, parental marriage model, Bowen patterns
14 — Session-by-Session Treatment Map	16-session plan with EFT steps + cumulative session log
15 — Weekly Tracking & Homework	Per-session rating, homework review/assign, positives tracker, progress graph

Attribution: Frameworks drawn from Harway, M. (Ed.). (2005). Handbook of Couples Therapy. John Wiley & Sons.

Worksheet 01 — First Session: Goals, Intake, Safety Screen & Alliance

Phase 1 — Assessment & Alliance · Session 1 *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 1 (Setting the Stage), Ch. 2 (PAIRS premarital assessment), Ch. 3 (first years of commitment), Ch. 8 (CBCT functional assessment), Ch. 11 (EFT Stage 1 / Step 1 assessment & alliance), Ch. 16–17 (safety screening).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose of Session 1:** establish the alliance, understand the couple's shared story, run a safety screen, surface the presenting problems, and set clear goals and expectations — *not* to solve problems or teach skills yet.
 - **Format:** Conjoint (both partners present). Book a **longer first session** (90–120 min) if possible. The PAIRS chapter stresses that the standard 50-minute hour "cannot build the trust, connectedness, and collaboration" an initial inquiry needs.
 - **EFT alignment (Step 1):** "In EFT the client is the relationship." Initiate and maintain a collaborative alliance in which each partner feels "sensitively listened to, understood, empathized with, and not blamed."
 - **Stance:** Warm, curious, multidirectionally partial (both partners feel joined). Reframe "who's at fault" into "what's the pattern."
 - **Fill it in together** on a shared surface for Parts C–F; complete Part B (safety) using your clinical interview and, if needed, brief separate check-ins.
 - **End the session** by setting up the individual sessions (Worksheet 02) and explaining your no-secrets / confidentiality policy.
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Part A — The Explicit Goals of the First Session (clinician checklist)

Work through — and tick off — each of these first-session goals before you close:

- ☐ **Build a working alliance** with *both* partners (neither feels you've sided with the other)
- ☐ **Create emotional safety** so each partner can speak honestly
- ☐ **Hear the presenting problem** from each partner in their own words
- ☐ **Understand the relationship story and context** (how they got here)
- ☐ **Screen for safety** (violence, abuse, addiction, acute risk) — see Part B
- ☐ **Assess suitability** for conjoint couples therapy right now
- ☐ **Begin to observe the negative interaction cycle** (don't interpret aloud yet)

- **Instill hope** — name a strength and normalize that change is possible
- **Set preliminary goals and expectations** for therapy
- **Establish the frame** — confidentiality, no-secrets policy, fees, logistics
- **Agree on next steps** (individual sessions, homework)

Part B — Safety & Suitability Screen (clinician completes)

Complete this early. If any item flags, follow the relevant module in Worksheet 07 and your jurisdiction's standards **before** proceeding to conjoint skills work. The EFT chapter explicitly notes assessment must screen "for factors that preclude the use of EFT, such as ongoing abuse or violence."

Screen	Finding / notes	Flag?
Current physical aggression / fear of partner		□
History of physical aggression (type, recency, severity)		□
Does either partner feel unsafe speaking freely today?		□
Active substance use / addiction affecting safety or participation		□
Acute risk: suicidal / homicidal ideation		□
Child-safety concerns / mandated-report issues		□
Known sexual-abuse history relevant to the couple's functioning		□
Active, undisclosed affair (may need individual check-in)		□
Is one partner here only to arrange separation/divorce?		□

Decision: □ Proceed with standard arc □ Proceed with modifications □ Pause for safety/individual work (specify): _____

Frame established: □ Confidentiality & limits □ No-secrets policy □ Fees/cancellation □ Telehealth safety plan (if applicable)

Part C — The Relationship Story (joint)

Adapted from the PAIRS joint-interview questions; applies to committed couples at any life-cycle stage.

- 1. **How did you meet?** _____
- 2. **What drew you to each other?** _____
- 3. **What made you decide to commit to this relationship?** _____
- 4. **What have been the high points of your relationship?** _____
- 5. **What life-cycle stage are you in?** (circle) premarital · newly committed · young children · adolescents at home · older/"empty nest" · later life
- 6. **What major transitions or stressors are you facing now?** (work, finances, health, children, extended family, moves, immigration) _____
- 7. **What are family responses to your relationship — and how do you each react to the other's family?** _____

Part D — Why Now? Presenting Concerns (joint)

	Partner A	Partner B
In your own words, what brings you here?		
How long has this been a problem?		
What finally made you call now?		
What have you already tried?		
Distress about the relationship (0–10)		
Commitment to working on it right now (0–10)		

The presenting problem may arrive three ways (Strategic/Haley, Ch. 12): through *an individual's symptom*, through *a child's problem*, or through *a direct request for couples work*. Note which:

See **Worksheet 10 — Presenting Problems Checklist** to map the full range of issues systematically.

Part E — First-Pass Goals & Expectations (joint)

- **What are you each seeking from this counseling?**
- Partner A: _____
- Partner B: _____
- **If therapy worked, what would be different?** (first look at the "miracle" question — developed in Worksheet 03) _____
- **What are your questions for me (the therapist)?** _____
- **Expectations I'm setting:** frequency _____ · estimated length _____ · active between-session practice ☐ agreed · how we handle crises _____

Full goal-setting is completed in **Worksheet 03** after assessment. This is a first pass to give the couple direction and hope.

Part F — Alliance & Observation (clinician notes)

Observe and note — do **not** share interpretations yet:

- Communication style under stress (Satir roles: placating · blaming · distracting · "computing"/over-rational · leveling): A _____ B _____
- Negative cycle you can already see (e.g., pursue-withdraw, criticize-defend):

- Each partner's apparent strengths / what's still working: _____
- Cultural, spiritual, gender, and socioeconomic context to hold in mind:

- Who seems more motivated / who is the "customer" for change? _____

Session 1 close-out

- ☐ All Part A first-session goals addressed
- ☐ Safety screen completed and decision recorded
- ☐ Relationship story and presenting concerns captured
- ☐ First-pass goals and expectations set

- Individual sessions scheduled (Worksheet 02); no-secrets policy explained
- Homework assigned from Worksheet 15 (e.g., each partner notices one thing they appreciate this week)
- Session rating (Worksheet 15)

Next: Worksheet 02 — Individual History Sessions. Also see Worksheet 10 (Presenting Problems) and Worksheet 11–12 (Assessment batteries).

Worksheet 02 — Individual History Sessions

Phase 1 — Assessment & Alliance · Sessions 2–3 (one per partner) *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 2 (PAIRS individual-interview format), Ch. 7 (Bowen: family-of-origin, differentiation), Ch. 9 (Object Relations: attachment patterns), Ch. 11 (EFT: attachment fears/needs), Ch. 14 (Feminist/Contextual: gendered expectations).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** Gather each partner's individual social and emotional history without the other's presence. The PAIRS chapter describes two-hour individual interviews that "open windows to new understandings that have not previously been realized or considered."
 - **Format:** Individual session, one partner at a time. Aim for 60–120 min.
 - **Stance:** Empathic, curious, non-judgmental. This is an opportunity for the individual to disclose what might be uncomfortable to share in a joint session.
 - **Confidentiality:** Begin by **restating your no-secrets policy** (decided in Session 1). Make clear how information shared here will and won't be used in conjoint sessions.
 - **What you're assessing:** Family conditioning, attachment styles, models from the parental marriage, invisible loyalties, expectations of the relationship, sexual/abuse history, personal hopes and fears, and individual contributing factors.
 - **Give each partner their own copy.** They may fill in some answers before the session or you may complete it interview-style.
 - **Safety check:** This is the best time to check for domestic violence indicators privately — ask directly.
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Part A — Identifying Information

Name: _____ Date: _____ Age: ____ Occupation: _____
Cultural / ethnic background: _____ Spiritual/religious affiliation: _____

Part B — Family of Origin (Bowen / PAIRS)

The Bowen family-systems chapter (Ch. 7) and the PAIRS chapter (Ch. 2) both emphasize that each partner's family conditioning shapes expectations and interactional style.

1. **Growing up, describe your family. Who was in it? What was the atmosphere?**
-

1. What was your parents' / caregivers' relationship like?

1. **How did your family handle conflict?** (avoided it · yelled · shut down · worked it through · violence was present · other: ____)

1. **How was affection expressed in your family?** (openly · rarely · conditionally · inconsistently · not at all · other: ____)

1. Describe your relationship with each parent/caregiver:

2. Parent/Caregiver 1: _____

3. Parent/Caregiver 2: _____

1. Sibling relationships (including competition, closeness, alliances):

1. Were there losses, traumas, or family secrets that shaped you?

1. **What invisible loyalties or unspoken rules did you absorb?** (e.g., "In our family, you never show weakness" or "You must always put family first")

1. **How differentiated do you feel from your family of origin?** (Bowen concept: can you hold your own position while staying emotionally connected?) 1 (very fused) ————— 5 (well differentiated) 10 (completely cut off)

Part C — Attachment History & Patterns (EFT / Object Relations)

The EFT chapter describes how attachment needs and fears organize couple interactions. Object Relations (Ch. 9) explores how internalized relationship models are projected into the couple bond.

1. As a child, when you were upset, who comforted you? How?

1. **Did you feel safe and secure growing up?** ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No — explain: ____

1. **When you are upset in your current relationship, what do you typically do?** (reach out · withdraw · get angry · shut down · placate · other: ____)

1. **What do you most need from your partner when you're hurting?** _____

1. **What are you most afraid of in close relationships?** (abandonment · engulfment/losing self · rejection · not being enough · betrayal · other: ____)

1. **Previous significant relationships and what led to their ending:**

1. **Describe your attachment style as you understand it:** ☐ Secure ☐ Anxious/preoccupied ☐ Avoidant/dismissing ☐ Disorganized/fearful ☐ Unsure

Part D — Expectations & Roles in This Relationship (Feminist/Contextual)

The Feminist/Contextual chapter (Ch. 14) highlights that gendered, cultural, and socioeconomic expectations powerfully shape couple interaction.

1. **What roles do you each play in the relationship?** (breadwinner, caretaker, organiser, emotional manager, disciplinarian, etc.)

1. **Are those roles fair? How do you feel about them?**

1. **What did your family teach you about gender roles in relationships?**

1. **What are your expectations around work/finances, parenting, household, sex/intimacy, and emotional support?**

Domain	My expectation	What I think my partner expects
Work / finances		
Household		
Parenting		
Sex / intimacy		
Emotional support		
Leisure / social life		

1. **Cultural, spiritual, or religious values that are important to you in this relationship:**

Part E — Strengths, Resources & Hopes

1. What do you love or value about your partner? _____
 2. What are your personal strengths that you bring to this relationship? _____
 3. What are your hopes and dreams for this relationship? _____
 4. On a scale of 0–10, how hopeful are you that therapy can help? _____
 5. What would need to happen for you to feel satisfied with the relationship? _____
-

Part F — Private Safety Check (clinician completes)

Ask directly and sensitively. Record observations.

- Do you ever feel afraid of your partner? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- Has your partner ever hurt you physically, sexually, emotionally, or financially? ☐ Y ☐ N — details: _____
- Have you ever hurt your partner? ☐ Y ☐ N — details: _____
- Is there anything you feel you cannot say in a joint session? ☐ Y ☐ N — details: _____
- Any current substance use affecting the relationship? ☐ Y ☐ N
- Any concerns about your own mental health? ☐ Y ☐ N

Clinician notes / safety decision: _____

Session close-out

- ☐ Family-of-origin history completed
- ☐ Attachment patterns and relationship expectations explored
- ☐ Private safety screen completed
- ☐ Feedback session scheduled (Worksheet 03) — both partners will return together
- ☐ Brief homework assigned from Worksheet 09

Next: Complete this worksheet with the other partner; then move to Worksheet 03 — Formulation & Treatment Plan (joint feedback session).

Worksheet 03 — Formulation, Feedback & Treatment Plan

Phase 2 — Formulation & Goals · Session 3–4 (joint feedback session) *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 2 (PAIRS feedback session), Ch. 8 (CBCT functional assessment & treatment plan), Ch. 11 (EFT cycle de-escalation formulation), Ch. 12 (Strategic/Solution-Focused: miracle question & scaling).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** Share with the couple your understanding of their pattern ("the cycle"), set collaborative goals, and establish the treatment plan. This is the bridge between assessment and active intervention.
 - **Format:** Joint session, ideally 90 min.
 - **Stance:** Present the formulation as a **shared cycle — not either partner's fault**. The PAIRS chapter models "relabeling and reframing many past behaviors and intentions, pointing out how blame is often not the issue." The EFT chapter describes mapping the negative cycle so both partners can "see through the smoke" and recognize they are each caught in it.
 - **How to deliver:** Walk through each section aloud; write or draw the cycle diagram together on paper or whiteboard. Ask the couple to correct, add, or adjust — this is collaborative, not the therapist "announcing a verdict."
 - **Important:** Only share individual-session material that a partner has agreed may be shared (per your no-secrets policy). Summarize themes, not verbatim disclosures.
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Part A — Summary of What We've Learned

The Couple's Strengths & Resources

(Name what's still working — start here to build hope before describing the cycle.)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Key Themes from Assessment

- Life-cycle stage and related stressors: _____
- Expectations that mesh: _____
- Expectations that clash: _____
- Cultural/spiritual/contextual factors to keep in mind: _____

	Partner A	Partner B
What would be different?		
What would your partner notice first?		

Scaling Questions

	Partner A	Partner B
On a 0–10 scale, where is the relationship now?		
What would one point higher look like?		
What would it take to get there?		

Shared Goals (negotiate together — list 3–5)

#	Goal (specific, behavioral where possible)	Priority (H/M/L)
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

Part D — Treatment Plan

Approach and rationale

Based on the assessment, the therapeutic approach(es) that best fit this couple include (clinician selects and explains):

- ☐ Cognitive Behavioral Couple Therapy (CBCT) — Ch. 8
- ☐ Emotionally Focused Therapy (EFT) — Ch. 11
- ☐ Solution-Focused / Strategic — Ch. 12
- ☐ Narrative Therapy — Ch. 10

- ☐ Object Relations — Ch. 9
- ☐ PAIRS skills framework — Ch. 2
- ☐ Bowen Systems — Ch. 7
- ☐ Integrative/eclectic

Estimated treatment length: _____ sessions

Session frequency: ☐ Weekly ☐ Bi-weekly ☐ Other: _____

Special modules indicated (see Worksheet 07):

- ☐ Illness / medical concerns
- ☐ Sexual-abuse history
- ☐ Physical aggression
- ☐ Addiction
- ☐ Infidelity
- ☐ Divorce facilitation
- ☐ Religious/spiritual differences
- ☐ Same-sex couple issues
- ☐ Socioeconomic stressors

Between-session expectations

- Each partner commits to: _____
- Homework will be assigned each session (Worksheet 09)
- How will we handle crises between sessions? _____

Part E — Couple's Reaction & Commitment

	Partner A	Partner B
Does this formulation / cycle map feel accurate?		
What would you add or change?		
Are you willing to commit to this plan?		
Anything that worries you about the plan?		

Clinician notes: _____

Session close-out

- ☐ Formulation shared and validated by both partners
- ☐ Goals agreed upon and documented
- ☐ Treatment plan recorded
- ☐ Homework assigned from Worksheet 09
- ☐ Session rating (Worksheet 09)

Next: Worksheet 04 — Communication & De-escalation Skills.

Worksheet 04 — Communication & De-escalation Skills

Phase 3 — De-escalation & Communication · Sessions 4-8 (and reinforced throughout) *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 2 (PAIRS Dialogue Guide, "complaining without blaming," I-messages), Ch. 8 (CBCT communication: Satir's placator/blamer/distractor/computer; Gordon's I-messages; speaker-listener), Ch. 11 (EFT de-escalation of the negative cycle), Ch. 15 (managing emotional reactivity).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** First active-change phase. Interrupt the negative cycle and build core communication skills: speaking without blame, listening with empathy, and de-escalating reactivity. The CBCT chapter names communication, problem-solving, and behavior exchange as the "lynchpins" of effective couples intervention — this worksheet covers communication.
- **Format:** Joint sessions. Teach a skill, then **have the couple practice it live in the room (enactment)** while you coach. Do not just explain — the EFT and Strategic chapters both emphasize in-session enactments over didactics.
- **Prerequisite:** Complete Phase 1-2 and the safety screen. If physical aggression is present, see Worksheet 07 **before** doing hot-topic communication work; teach the Time-Out tool first and keep topics low-intensity.
- **Pacing:** Start with low-conflict topics; raise intensity only as the couple demonstrates skill. The therapist uses "shifts in intensity" (slowing tone, volume, pacing) to keep the room workable (Minuchin/EFT principle).

Tool 1 — Identify Your Communication Style Under Stress (Satir)

Each partner circles the style they fall into most under stress (CBCT, Ch. 8, citing Satir):

Style	What it sounds like
Placator	"It's fine, whatever you want, I'm sorry" — appeasing, self-erasing
Blamer	"You always... you never..." — accusing, fault-finding
Distractor	Changes subject, jokes, goes off-topic to avoid
Computer	Over-rational, cold, detached, "just the facts"
Leveler (goal)	Honest, direct, congruent — words match feelings

- Partner A's usual style: _____ Partner B's usual style: _____
- **Goal:** move toward *leveling* — congruent, honest, non-blaming communication.

Tool 2 — I-Messages / Complaining Without Blaming (PAIRS Dialogue Guide)

The PAIRS Dialogue Guide is "a communication tool for complaining without blaming." Convert blame-statements into I-messages.

Formula:

"When ____ (specific situation/behavior), I felt ____ (emotion), because ____ (meaning/need). What I'd like is ____ (request)."

Practice conversions:

Blame statement ("you" message)	I-message rewrite
"You never help around here."	
"You always ignore me."	
"You're so controlling."	
<i>(couple's own example)</i>	

Rule from PAIRS: "Express important hurt, fear, or irritation directly to each other in words, asking to be heard and understood with empathy. What is left unsaid is often more harmful than what is said."

Tool 3 — Speaker-Listener Technique (CBCT)

A structured turn-taking format that slows reactivity.

Speaker rules:

- Speak for yourself (use I-messages)
- Keep it brief — a few sentences, then pause
- Don't mind-read or accuse

Listener rules:

- Don't rebut, defend, or problem-solve
- Paraphrase back what you heard: *"What I hear you saying is..."*
- Check: *"Did I get that right?"*

- Only then does the Speaker continue or hand over the floor

In-session practice log:

Round	Topic (start low-intensity)	Did Speaker use I-messages?	Did Listener paraphrase accurately?	Coaching notes
1		☐	☐	
2		☐	☐	

Tool 4 — Empathic Listening Checklist

For the Listener (adapted from PAIRS listening skills):

- ☐ I made eye contact / turned toward my partner
- ☐ I did not interrupt
- ☐ I paraphrased what I heard before responding
- ☐ I checked whether I understood correctly
- ☐ I acknowledged my partner's feeling, even if I disagree with the content
- ☐ I set aside my rebuttal to truly hear them first

PAIRS competency: "Give up being right. Invite and express diversity. Welcome differences as sources of vigor, perspective, and healthy growth."

Tool 5 — Uncovering "Love Knots" / Hidden Expectations (PAIRS)

"Love Knots" are hidden expectations and mind-reading assumptions — e.g., *"If you really loved me, you would know..."*

Each partner lists hidden expectations they've been holding:

"If you really loved me, you would..."	Have you actually told your partner this?
	☐ Y ☐ N
	☐ Y ☐ N
	☐ Y ☐ N

Discussion: How might unspoken expectations be fueling disappointment? Practice stating the expectation directly as a request.

Tool 6 — The Time-Out / De-escalation Plan (managing emotional reactivity, Ch. 15)

When reactivity spikes, the couple needs an agreed exit ramp. (Essential when aggression history is present — see Worksheet 07.)

Our Time-Out agreement:

- Our signal word/gesture to call a time-out: _____
- Either partner can call it — no questions asked.
- During a time-out we will: (go to separate rooms · take a walk · breathe · no following/pursuing)
- We will come back and resume within _____ minutes/hours.
- Self-soothing I will do during the break (Partner A): _____
- Self-soothing I will do during the break (Partner B): _____

Physiological self-regulation: notice the body's early warning signs (racing heart, heat, tight chest). Name them before escalation: Partner A's signs _____ Partner B's signs _____

Between-session practice (assign in Worksheet 09)

- ☐ Daily 15-minute Speaker–Listener "appreciation" check-in on a *positive* topic
- ☐ Each partner converts 3 blame-thoughts into I-messages and brings them to next session
- ☐ Practice one time-out if reactivity rises; report how it went

Session close-out

- ☐ Skill(s) taught and practiced in-session with coaching
- ☐ Time-out plan agreed
- ☐ Homework assigned (Worksheet 09)
- ☐ Session rating (Worksheet 09)

Next: Worksheet 05 (emotion/attachment restructuring) and/or Worksheet 06 (cognitive restructuring & problem-solving) depending on your treatment plan.

Worksheet 05 — Emotion & Attachment Restructuring (EFT-informed)

Phase 4 — Restructuring the Bond · Sessions 8–14 *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 11 (EFT: emotion, attachment, enactments, softening, attachment injuries), Ch. 9 (Object Relations: projective identification, internalized models), Ch. 15 (emotional reactivity).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** Move from *de-escalating* the cycle (Phase 3) to *restructuring the emotional bond*. EFT frames couple distress as insecurity in the attachment bond: rigid interaction patterns organized by "absorbing affect states." The task is to access the softer, underlying emotions and attachment needs that drive the surface behavior, and to create new bonding interactions.
 - **When to use:** After the couple has achieved some de-escalation (they can talk about the cycle without the cycle taking over). EFT describes this as moving beyond "critical pursuit followed by distance and defensiveness."
 - **Format:** Joint sessions. Heavy use of **in-session enactments** — you direct partners to turn and speak the newly accessed emotion *to each other*, not to you.
 - **Stance:** Clients are the experts on their own experience; do not pathologize or label. "They are viewed as struggling with problems arising from a particular social context." Validate, reflect, and heighten emotion gently.
 - **Caution:** Deep emotional work can surface trauma or attachment injuries (including infidelity or abuse). Have Worksheet 07 ready; pace to the couple's window of tolerance.
-

Tool 1 — Secondary vs. Primary Emotion Map

Surface (secondary/reactive) emotions protect us but drive the negative cycle. Underneath are primary (vulnerable) emotions and attachment needs.

	Partner A	Partner B
Secondary emotion (what shows on the surface — often anger, criticism, numbness, withdrawal)		
Primary emotion (underneath — hurt, fear, loneliness, shame, longing)		
The attachment question underneath (e.g., <i>"Are you there for me? Do I matter to you? Will you leave?"</i>)		

Clinician prompt to access primary emotion: "When you [withdraw/criticize] in that moment... just underneath the [anger/silence], what's the softer feeling? What are you afraid of?"

Tool 2 — Attachment Needs & Fears

Each partner names their core attachment needs and fears (built from Worksheet 02, Part C).

	Partner A	Partner B
My deepest need in this relationship is...		
My biggest fear in this relationship is...		
When I don't get my need met, I tend to...		
What would help me feel safe/secure is...		

EFT goal: help each partner express needs *from a vulnerable place* and the other respond with accessibility, responsiveness, and engagement.

Tool 3 — Enactment Script (the heart of EFT change events)

Direct the couple to turn toward each other and speak the newly accessed emotion. Use this as a scaffold:

Pursuer softening / Withdrawer re-engaging:

1. Partner, turn to [name]. Can you tell them: *"When this happens, underneath I feel ____ (primary emotion)."*
2. *"What I really need from you in those moments is ____."*
3. *"It's hard for me to say this because ____."*

Listener's response (coach them):

- *"When I hear you say that, I feel ____."*
- *"What I want you to know is ____."*
- *"I want to be there for you by ____."*

Enactment log:

Date	What was accessed / expressed	How partner responded	Shift observed?

Tool 4 — Attachment Injury Repair

An "attachment injury" is a moment of betrayal or abandonment at a critical time (e.g., not being there during a loss, an affair, a broken promise) that becomes a recurring wound blocking trust. EFT describes specific work on these injuries.

Identify the injury:

- What happened, and when? _____
- Why was this moment so critical for the injured partner? _____
- What did it come to *mean* about the relationship / your safety? _____

Repair steps (guide the couple through, in order):

1. **Injured partner** stays with and expresses the pain and its attachment meaning (not just the facts).
2. **Other partner** stays present, hears the impact without defending, and acknowledges the hurt they caused.
3. **Other partner** expresses genuine remorse and understanding of the injury's significance.
4. **Injured partner** begins to risk asking for what they need now to feel safe.
5. The couple creates a new, corrective bonding moment.

Links to PAIRS competency: "Seek forgiveness for hurts by taking responsibility, repairing damages, and expressing regret. Let go of grudges and choose to forgive."

Repair tracking:

Step	Done?	Notes
Injury named & its meaning expressed	☐	
Impact heard without defensiveness	☐	
Genuine remorse expressed	☐	
Needs for safety now articulated	☐	
New bonding moment created	☐	

Tool 5 — Object Relations Reflection (optional, Ch. 9)

For couples where old internalized relationship "templates" are being projected onto the partner:

- "Who does your partner remind you of when you're triggered?" _____
- "What old relationship pattern might be getting replayed here?" _____
- "Is the feeling the size of *this* moment, or does it carry something older?" _____

Use to help partners separate the present partner from historical figures (de-projection).

Tool 6 — Creating New Bonding Rituals (PAIRS)

Restructuring isn't complete without positive bonding. From PAIRS competencies:

- **Regular bonding** with "an abundance of physical closeness and emotional openness."
- **Play, pleasure, recreation, humor** to balance the hard work.
- **Daily/weekly rituals** we will build: _____
- **Expressions of gratitude and appreciation** we will practice: _____

Between-session practice (assign in Worksheet 09)

- ☐ One "vulnerability conversation" at home using the enactment script
- ☐ Each partner performs one specific act that meets the other's stated attachment need

- Daily bonding ritual (hug □ 20s, check-in, gratitude)

Session close-out

- Primary emotions accessed and expressed in-session
- Attachment needs named by both partners
- Enactment(s) completed with coaching
- Homework assigned (Worksheet 09)
- Session rating (Worksheet 09)

Next: Worksheet 06 (cognitive restructuring & problem-solving) for concrete issues, and interweave Worksheet 07 modules as indicated.

Worksheet 06 — Cognitive Restructuring, Problem-Solving & Behavior Exchange (CBCT)

Phase 4 — Restructuring the Bond · Sessions 6–14 (interwoven) *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 8 (Cognitive Behavioral Couple Therapy: functional assessment, communication, problem-solving, behavior exchange, attributions, caring days/acceptance & commitment), Ch. 12 (solution-focused exceptions).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** The CBCT chapter identifies three "lynchpins" of effective couples intervention: **communication** (Worksheet 04), **problem-solving**, and **behavior exchange** — plus the cognitive layer of **attributions and beliefs**. This worksheet covers the cognitive and problem-solving/behavioral components.
- **Grounding principle:** "Before any clinical theory or technique is applied, a functional assessment should be conducted to guide treatment planning." Make sure Phase 1–2 is complete.
- **Format:** Joint sessions; teach, model, and practice in-session, then assign as homework. CBCT is explicitly skills- and practice-oriented.
- **Balance:** The chapter warns that behavioral work alone has been stereotyped as "cold and sterile." Pair these tools with the emotional and relationship focus of Worksheet 05 so the couple experiences warmth, not mechanics. Enhanced CBCT encompasses "personal characteristics, past history, and the total context of the couple's environment."
- **Match to orientation:** This worksheet is the core toolkit for CBCT-oriented clinicians and a useful supplement for others.

Tool 1 — Thought Record (Cognitive Restructuring)

Distressing couple interactions are often driven by automatic thoughts and interpretations, not just the event itself.

Situation (what happened)	Automatic thought / interpreta tion	Emotion (0–100)	Behavior that followed	Evidence for the thought	Evidence against	Balanced / alternativ e thought	New emotion (0–100)

Clinician note: Have each partner complete their own. Then compare: often the same event produced very different interpretations.

Tool 2 — Attribution Check (CBCT)

The chapter cautions that excessive focus on attributions can crowd out needed behavior-exchange skills — so use this as a brief, targeted tool. Distressed couples tend to attribute negative behavior to the partner's **stable, global, intentional** character ("he's selfish") rather than to situation.

For a recent upsetting event, each partner answers:

Question	Partner A	Partner B
What did your partner do?		
Why do you think they did it? (your explanation)		
Is your explanation about their <i>character</i> ("they always, they're the kind of person who...") or the <i>situation</i> ?		
What's a more charitable or situational explanation?		

PAIRS link: "Extend goodwill and positive intent." Reattributing toward benign/situational explanations reduces reactivity.

Tool 3 — Identifying & Testing Relationship Beliefs/Standards

Unrealistic standards fuel conflict (CBCT; cf. "Love Knots" in Worksheet 04).

My belief / standard about relationships	Realistic? Flexible?	Revised, more flexible version
"A good partner should always know what I need."		
"Disagreement means we're incompatible."		
(couple's own)		

Tool 4 — Structured Problem-Solving (CBCT)

A step-by-step format for a specific, solvable issue (keep emotionally charged relational wounds for Worksheet 05).

1. **Define the problem specifically** (one issue, behavioral terms): _____
2. **Each partner states their perspective** (I-messages, Worksheet 04): _____
3. **Brainstorm solutions** — all ideas welcome, no judging yet:
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. **Evaluate options together** (pros/cons):

Option	Pros	Cons

1. **Choose a solution to try** (compromise acceptable to both): _____
 2. **Agree on specifics:** who does what, by when? _____
 3. **Set a review date** to evaluate how it worked: _____
-

Tool 5 — Behavior Exchange & "Caring Days" (CBCT / Stuart)

Stuart's "caring days": each partner devotes days to doing specific activities requested by the other.

Each partner lists small, specific, positive behaviors they would appreciate (concrete and doable — e.g., "bring me coffee in the morning," "ask about my day and listen," "text me a nice note"):

Partner A would appreciate...	Partner B would appreciate...
1.	1.
2.	2.
3.	3.
4.	4.
5.	5.

Agreement: This week, each partner will do **at least** ____ **caring behaviors per day** from the other's list — *independent of whether the partner reciprocates* (no scorekeeping). The emphasis is on

positive exchange, not tit-for-tat.

Tool 6 — Acceptance vs. Change (Integrative Behavioral CBCT)

Not every difference can or should be changed. The chapter describes facilitating "acceptance by one partner of the other's specific behavior, rather than attempting to change it."

Issue	Can realistically change?	Needs acceptance?	Our approach
	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	

Commitment (the other half of acceptance & commitment): *"Willingness to put forth the necessary effort to make the relationship succeed."* Each partner names one commitment: _____

Tool 7 — Exceptions / What's Already Working (Solution-Focused, Ch. 12)

- "Tell me about a recent time the problem *could* have happened but didn't — what was different?" _____
- "What were you each doing differently during that exception?" _____
- "How can you do more of that?" _____

Between-session practice (assign in Worksheet 09)

- ☐ Each partner completes 2 thought records on upsetting moments
- ☐ Daily caring behaviors from the partner's list (no scorekeeping)
- ☐ Try the agreed problem-solving solution; note results for review

Session close-out

- ☐ Cognitive/attribution tool practiced
- ☐ Problem-solving or behavior-exchange agreement reached
- ☐ Homework assigned (Worksheet 09)
- ☐ Session rating (Worksheet 09)

Next: Interweave Worksheet 07 (special issues) as indicated; progress toward Worksheet 08 (consolidation & termination).

Worksheet 07 — Special Issues Modules

Phase 5 — Special Issues (interwoven as indicated) *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 15 (Illness/medical), Ch. 16 (Sexual abuse history), Ch. 17 (Physical aggression), Ch. 18 (Addiction), Ch. 19 (Infidelity), Ch. 20 (Religious/spiritual), Ch. 21 (Same-sex couples), Ch. 22 (Socioeconomic factors), Ch. 23 (Divorce).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** The *Handbook* devotes all of Section III to special presentations that require specific clinical adaptations. These modules are **not** meant to replace the session arc — they are **add-ons** or **sequence modifiers** to Worksheets 01–06.
 - **When to use:** When the safety screen (Worksheet 01, Part A) or individual sessions (Worksheet 02) identify any of these issues.
 - **Format:** Select the relevant module(s); integrate its assessment and intervention prompts into the treatment plan (Worksheet 03, Part D). Some modules (aggression, addiction) alter the standard sequence — follow the sequencing notes carefully.
 - **Scope:** These modules are brief assessment-and-planning aids, not comprehensive treatments. Consult the corresponding *Handbook* chapter and the relevant primary clinical literature for depth.
-

Module A — Couples Facing Illness / Medical Concerns (Ch. 15)

Core framework: The interaction between biological and emotional — illness disrupts the couple's roles, intimacy, and emotional regulation.

Assessment questions:

1. What is the medical condition / diagnosis? _____
2. Who is the patient and who is the caregiver? _____
3. How has illness changed your daily roles and routines? _____
4. How has illness affected your emotional connection and intimacy? _____
5. On a 0–10 scale, how well are you managing the emotional roller coaster? Partner A: ____ Partner B: ____

Intervention prompts:

- Help the couple develop shared understanding of the illness and its practical demands
- Address caregiver burnout and the patient's guilt/loss of autonomy

- Use emotional reactivity management techniques (Worksheet 04, Tool 6)
 - Normalize grief for the "lost" relationship/life before the illness
 - Support practical problem-solving for medical demands (Worksheet 06)
-

Module B — Sexual-Abuse History (Ch. 16)

Core framework: A history of sexual abuse in one partner "may affect the overall couple's functioning and may lead to difficult therapeutic concerns."

Safety-first sequencing:

"If sexual abuse is ruled out at intake, the standard clinical assessment protocol for couples may be implemented." If abuse IS present: individual trauma assessment and stabilization come first or alongside.

Assessment questions (with the individual partner — Worksheet 02):

1. Has the survivor received or is currently in individual trauma therapy? ☐ Y ☐ N
2. Is the partner aware of the abuse history? ☐ Y ☐ N ☐ Partially
3. How does the abuse history show up in the couple's dynamic? (triggers, avoidance, sexual difficulties, trust issues) _____
4. Does the partner feel they "walk on eggshells" or feel shut out? _____

Intervention focus:

- Psychoeducation: both partners learn how trauma affects the nervous system and relational behavior
 - Pacing: go slow with emotional vulnerability (Worksheet 05) — stay within the survivor's window of tolerance
 - Address the non-abused partner's feelings (helplessness, frustration) without centering them
 - Refer for individual trauma work if not already in place
 - Build a safety plan for triggered moments (link to Worksheet 04, Time-Out)
-

Module C — Physical Aggression / Domestic Violence (Ch. 17)

Safety-first sequencing:

Conjoint communication work can be **contraindicated** when active violence is present. This decision must be made at intake and revisited.

Level-of-risk assessment (clinician completes):

Factor	Partner A → B	Partner B → A
Type of aggression (physical, psychological, sexual, financial, technology)		
Frequency and recency		
Severity / injury		
Fear level of the partner (scale 0–10)		
Use of coercive control?	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
History of escalation?	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
Weapons involvement?	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N

Decision tree:

- **Active high-risk violence or coercive control** → Conjoint therapy is not appropriate at this time. Individual safety planning, refer to DV services, potentially batterer-intervention program.
- **Situational couple violence (low severity, mutual, no fear/coercion)** → Conjoint may proceed with modifications: Time-Out plan (Worksheet 04) must be in place first; topics are carefully titrated; aggression is monitored every session.

Safety plan (always complete when any aggression history):

- Emergency numbers (local DV hotline, crisis line): _____
- Safe person to call: _____
- Safe place to go: _____
- How to signal the therapist between sessions: _____

Module D — Addiction (Ch. 18)

Core framework: Key elements of couples therapy integrated with treatment of addictive behaviors.

Assessment:

1. Substance(s) or behavior(s) of concern: _____
2. Current use level and pattern: _____
3. Is the individual currently in treatment for the addiction? ☐ Y ☐ N
4. Stage of change (precontemplation / contemplation / preparation / action / maintenance): _____

5. How does the addiction affect the couple's functioning? _____

6. Enabling / co-dependent patterns? _____

Sequencing note: Active untreated addiction may need to be addressed (at minimum harm-reduction or individual addiction treatment) before deep couples work can be effective — the cycle cannot be interrupted if substances are fueling it.

Intervention focus:

- Psychoeducation: addiction as a biopsychosocial pattern affecting the couple system
 - Map the cycle with addiction included (who uses when, what triggers it, how partner responds, how that response feeds the cycle)
 - Rebuild trust (overlaps with Module F)
 - Relapse-prevention planning that includes the couple (Worksheet 08)
-

Module E — Infidelity (Ch. 19)

Core framework: Infidelity "affects a large number of couples and presents particular challenges." Ch. 19 proposes an effective model for intervention.

Assessment:

1. Nature of the infidelity (emotional, physical, online, ongoing/ended): _____
2. How was it discovered? _____
3. When? _____ How recently? _____
4. Has the affair/contact ended? ☐ Y ☐ N ☐ Unclear
5. Disclosure status: ☐ Full disclosure ☐ Partial ☐ Still emerging
6. Impact on the betrayed partner (0–10 distress): _____
7. Remorse level of the involved partner (0–10): _____

Phase-specific work:

- **Phase 1 — Crisis stabilization:** Contain the acute emotional flooding. No major decisions yet. Rule out safety concerns.
 - **Phase 2 — Understanding:** Why did it happen? (not to excuse, but to understand the relational context). Map it onto the cycle (Worksheet 03).
 - **Phase 3 — Rebuilding trust:** Transparency, accountability, addressing the attachment injury (Worksheet 05, Tool 4). "Taking responsibility for transgressions, repairing damages, and expressing regret" (PAIRS).
 - **Phase 4 — Decision:** Can the relationship be repaired? New commitment or transition to divorce (Module G)?
-

Module F — Religious / Spiritual Issues (Ch. 20)

Assessment:

1. Spiritual/religious affiliation of each partner: Partner A _____ Partner B _____
2. Importance of spirituality to each (0–10): A ____ B ____
3. Points of harmony: _____
4. Points of conflict: _____
5. Are spiritual differences contributing to couple distress? _____

Intervention focus:

- Create a safe space to discuss spiritual beliefs without judgment
 - Acknowledge spiritual differences as one form of cultural difference
 - Explore how spiritual values can be a resource for healing
 - Respect that therapy should not impose the therapist's beliefs
-

Module G — Divorce / Dissolution (Ch. 23)

Decision check-in:

- Is one or both partners here to end the relationship rather than repair it? ☐ A ☐ B ☐ Both ☐ Neither
- Are they open to exploring the relationship first? ☐ Y ☐ N

If proceeding toward dissolution:

- Shift goals to a smooth, respectful transition
 - Address co-parenting plan if children are involved
 - Manage the emotional process of grief and loss
 - Refer for legal/financial resources as needed
 - Prevent adversarial dynamics that harm children or each other
-

Module H — Same-Sex Couples (Ch. 21)

Assessment of unique stressors:

- Degree of openness about the relationship (out to family, work, community): _____
- Internalized stigma / minority stress affecting the relationship: _____
- Legal protections / lack thereof: _____
- Role-negotiation without default gendered scripts: _____

- Family-of-origin acceptance: _____

Worksheets 01–06 apply to all couples. This module adds the lens of specific stressors that same-sex couples navigate that are unique to their context.

Module I — Socioeconomic Stressors (Ch. 22)

Assessment:

- Financial stress level (0–10): Partner A ____ Partner B ____
- Employment stability: _____
- Housing stability: _____
- Access to healthcare/childcare: _____
- How do money issues show up in the couple's cycle? _____

Intervention focus:

- Practical financial problem-solving (Worksheet 06)
- Addressing power dynamics related to income/earning
- Normalizing the impact of economic stress on the relationship

Clinician notes

After reviewing relevant modules, update the Treatment Plan (Worksheet 03, Part D) to reflect:

- Which modules are active: _____
- Sequencing changes needed: _____
- External referrals made: _____

Next: Continue standard arc (Worksheets 04–06); progress toward Worksheet 08 (consolidation & termination).

Worksheet 08 — Consolidation, Relapse Prevention & Termination

Phase 6 — Consolidation & Termination · Final 2–3 Sessions *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 2 (PAIRS: rituals, sustaining relationships, gratitude), Ch. 11 (EFT: consolidation stage, new positions), Ch. 24 (What the research tells us), Ch. 25 (concluding thoughts).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** Consolidate gains, help the couple internalize new patterns, build relapse prevention, and end the therapy relationship well. In EFT terms, this is the consolidation stage where new, more secure interactional positions are stabilized and the couple's new "story" of their relationship is reinforced.
- **Format:** Joint sessions, usually the final 2–3. Spread termination over more than one session so it isn't abrupt.
- **Stance:** Shift authority back to the couple — they are now the experts on their own relationship. Highlight what *they* did, not what you did.
- **Review material:** Pull out the goals (Worksheet 03), the cycle map, and completed tracking sheets (Worksheet 09) to review progress concretely.

Part A — Reviewing the Journey

Progress on original goals (from Worksheet 03)

Goal	Where we started (0–10)	Where we are now (0–10)	Still working on?
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

What changed

	Partner A	Partner B
The biggest change I notice in myself		
The biggest change I notice in you		
The biggest change in us as a couple		
What I'm most proud of		

Part B — Understanding Our Cycle (then vs. now)

- **Our old negative cycle was:** _____
- **How we catch it now, early:** _____
- **Our new, more secure pattern looks like:** _____
- **Our signal to each other when we're slipping into the old cycle:** _____

Part C — Relapse Prevention Plan

Distress will recur — the goal is that the couple can recover on their own.

1. Our early-warning signs that we're drifting back into the old pattern:

1. High-risk situations / triggers to watch for (stress, holidays, transitions, illness, in-laws):

1. Our toolkit — what we'll do when the cycle shows up:

- ☐ Call a time-out (Worksheet 04)
- ☐ Use I-messages / Speaker-Listener (Worksheet 04)
- ☐ Name the primary emotion and attachment need (Worksheet 05)
- ☐ Return to a thought record / problem-solving steps (Worksheet 06)
- ☐ Reconnect with a bonding ritual

7. Other: _____

1. When would we come back to therapy? (agree on criteria for a "tune-up" session)

Part D — Sustaining the Relationship (PAIRS competencies)

Build durable habits from the PAIRS "Attitudes and Strategies for Successful Long-Term Relationships":

- **Regular bonding ritual** (physical closeness + emotional openness): _____
 - **Play / recreation / humor** we commit to: _____
 - **Expressing hurt/fear directly** rather than leaving it unsaid: our practice is _____
 - **Repair ritual** when we hurt each other (seek forgiveness, take responsibility): _____
 - **"Give up being right"** — welcome differences: our reminder is _____
 - **Weekly gratitude / appreciation ritual**: _____
 - **A unique relationship identity / rituals / customs we're building**: _____
 - **Connection to friends, community, extended family** for support: _____
-

Part E — Letters / Appreciations (optional closing exercise)

Each partner writes or speaks aloud to the other:

- "What I appreciate most about going through this with you is..." _____
 - "What I'm committing to going forward is..." _____
 - "What I hope for us is..." _____
-

Part F — Ending the Therapy Relationship

- **Acknowledge the work and the ending.** Name what the couple accomplished.
 - **Normalize mixed feelings** about ending.
 - **Confirm the door is open** for future tune-up sessions.
 - **Provide resources:** books, PAIRS or skills courses, support resources relevant to any special-issue modules used.
 - **Clinician reflection / discharge summary:**
 - Presenting problem: _____
 - Approach used: _____
 - Goals met / partially met / not met: _____
 - Recommendations / referrals: _____
 - Follow-up plan: _____
-

Session close-out

- Goals reviewed with concrete before/after ratings
- Relapse-prevention plan written and given to the couple
- Sustaining rituals committed to
- Resources and tune-up criteria provided
- Discharge summary documented
- Final session rating (Worksheet 09)

Research reminder (Ch. 24): Positive gains from effective couples work (especially EFT) tend to be stable with relatively low relapse; a clear relapse-prevention plan supports maintenance. Reinforce the couple's own agency in sustaining change.

Worksheet 10 — Presenting Problems Checklist & Problem Map

Phase 1 — Assessment • Session 1–2 *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 1 (common presentations), Section III (special issues: illness, abuse, aggression, addiction, infidelity, spiritual, same-sex, socioeconomic, divorce), Ch. 3 (early-marriage adjustment areas), Ch. 8 (functional assessment of the target problem).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** Systematically identify *all* the problems a couple brings — not just the one they lead with. Couples often present a "surface" complaint while a deeper or more dangerous issue sits underneath. This checklist ensures nothing is missed and feeds the functional assessment (Worksheet 11) and formulation (Worksheet 03).
 - **Format:** Give **each partner their own copy** to complete independently, then compare in session. Divergence between the two lists is itself clinically meaningful.
 - **Rank:** After checking all that apply, have each partner rank their **top 3** by distress.
 - **Safety:** Any item in the "Safety-sensitive" section triggers the matching module in Worksheet 07 and may change the treatment sequence.
-

Part A — Communication & Conflict

- ☐ We argue frequently / can't stop fighting
- ☐ We avoid conflict / never resolve anything
- ☐ One of us criticizes; the other withdraws
- ☐ Contempt, name-calling, or disrespect
- ☐ Defensiveness — no one takes responsibility
- ☐ Stonewalling / silent treatment
- ☐ We can't talk about hard topics without it blowing up
- ☐ Poor listening / feeling unheard
- ☐ Mind-reading / assuming the worst

Part B — Emotional Connection & Intimacy

- ☐ We feel like roommates / have grown apart
- ☐ Loss of affection or warmth
- ☐ Not feeling loved, valued, or appreciated

- Loneliness within the relationship
- Loss of trust
- Emotional distance / walls up
- One pursues closeness; the other needs space

Part C — Sex & Physical Intimacy

- Mismatched desire / frequency
- Loss of sexual interest
- Sexual dissatisfaction
- Sexual difficulties / dysfunction
- Impact of past sexual trauma (□ Worksheet 07, Module B)
- Pornography or compulsive sexual behavior concerns

Part D — Roles, Household & Parenting

- Unfair division of household labor
- Disagreements about parenting
- Child/adolescent problems straining the couple (□ Ch. 4–5)
- Blended-family / step-parenting conflict
- Caregiving burden (child, elder, or ill partner)
- Different values about work vs. family time

Part E — Money & Life Logistics

- Financial stress / insufficient income (□ Worksheet 07, Module I)
- Conflict over spending / saving / debt
- Power imbalance tied to earning
- Disagreement about major decisions (moving, career, kids)

Part F — External & Contextual Stressors

- Extended-family / in-law conflict
- Cultural or ethnic differences causing friction
- Religious / spiritual differences (□ Worksheet 07, Module F)
- Minority stress / lack of acceptance (□ Worksheet 07, Module H)
- Work stress, unemployment, or relocation
- Health / chronic illness / disability (□ Worksheet 07, Module A)
- Grief / recent loss

Part G — Safety-Sensitive (always review carefully)

- ☐ Physical aggression / violence (☐ Worksheet 07, Module C) ☐
 - ☐ Fear of partner / coercive control ☐
 - ☐ Emotional / verbal / financial abuse ☐
 - ☐ Addiction — alcohol, drugs, gambling, etc. (☐ Module D) ☐
 - ☐ Infidelity — discovered or suspected (☐ Module E)
 - ☐ Mental-health crisis / self-harm risk ☐
 - ☐ One or both considering separation/divorce (☐ Module G)
-

Part H — Problem Ranking & Comparison

Each partner lists their **top 3** most distressing problems:

Rank	Partner A's top problems	Partner B's top problems
1		
2		
3		

Where do the lists agree? _____

Where do they differ? (differences are clinically important)

Part I — Functional Analysis of the Lead Problem (clinician + couple)

For the agreed primary problem, map its function (CBCT functional assessment):

- **Specific, observable description of the problem:** _____
 - **Antecedents / triggers** (when, where, with whom): _____
 - **Each partner's behavior during it:** A _____ B _____
 - **Consequences** (what happens right after — what reinforces it): _____
 - **What each partner is protecting / avoiding:** A _____ B _____
 - **Exceptions** — when does it NOT happen? _____
-

Session close-out

- Both partners completed the checklist independently
- Top-3 problems ranked and compared
- Lead problem functionally analyzed
- Any safety-sensitive flags routed to Worksheet 07
- Carry findings into Worksheet 11 (Assessment) and Worksheet 03 (Formulation)

Next: Worksheet 11 — Comprehensive Couple Assessment Battery.

Worksheet 11 — Comprehensive Couple Assessment Battery

Phase 1 — Assessment • Sessions 1–3 *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 2 (PAIRS multi-session assessment format), Ch. 8 (CBCT functional assessment & assessment domains), Ch. 11 (EFT Step 1 assessment of cycle, attachment insecurities, longings & needs), Ch. 7 (Bowen differentiation), Ch. 24 (what research says distinguishes well-functioning couples).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** A structured, multi-domain assessment covering every area the *Handbook* says matters before you plan treatment: the couple's history, the interaction cycle, each partner's individual functioning, attachment, strengths, and risk. The CBCT chapter is explicit: *"Before any clinical theory or technique is applied, a functional assessment should be conducted to guide treatment planning."*
 - **Format:** This is a **clinician-administered battery** spread across the first 2–3 sessions (joint + individual). The PAIRS model uses a joint interview, then two individual interviews, then a joint feedback session — this worksheet supports all of those.
 - **Scope:** Not every domain needs equal depth for every couple. Prioritize based on the presenting problems (Worksheet 10).
 - **Output:** Findings feed directly into the formulation and treatment plan (Worksheet 03).
-

Domain 1 — Relationship History & Commitment

- Length of relationship: _____ Married/partnered since: _____
- Cohabiting? ☐ Y ☐ N • Children (ages): _____
- Prior marriages/significant relationships: _____
- Commitment level now (0–10): A ____ B ____
- Has either partner "one foot out the door"? ☐ A ☐ B ☐ Neither

Domain 2 — The Interaction Cycle (EFT Step 1–2)

Get a *"blow-by-blow account"* of a recent argument — "as if listening to a live event broadcast on the radio" — focusing on who does what, when, then what next.

- **Trigger topic:** _____
- **Partner A does:** _____ ☐ **Partner B responds:** _____ ☐ **then A:** _____ ☐ **then B:** _____

- **The repeating pattern:** (pursue–withdraw · attack–defend · demand–withdraw · both withdraw · both escalate) _____
- **Where each ends up emotionally:** A _____ B _____

Domain 3 — Attachment Assessment (EFT / Object Relations)

	Partner A	Partner B
Attachment style (secure / anxious / avoidant / disorganized)		
Core attachment longing		
Core attachment fear		
Strategy when the bond feels threatened		

Domain 4 — Individual Functioning Screen

For each partner, screen (refer out as needed — couples work alone may be insufficient):

Factor	Partner A	Partner B
Current mental-health concerns (depression, anxiety, trauma, etc.)		
Substance use		
Medical / chronic illness		
In individual therapy / on medication?		
History of trauma or abuse		

Domain 5 — Differentiation of Self (Bowen, Ch. 7)

For each partner (1 = highly fused/reactive, 10 = well-differentiated):

	Partner A	Partner B
Can hold own position under pressure	0-10:	0-10:
Can stay connected while disagreeing	0-10:	0-10:
Emotional reactivity level	0-10:	0-10:
Degree of cutoff or fusion with family of origin		

Domain 6 — Communication & Problem-Solving Skills

Skill	Rating (poor / fair / good)	Notes
Speaking without blame		
Listening / understanding partner		
Expressing feelings directly		
Repair after conflict		
Negotiating / compromising		
Managing physiological flooding		

Domain 7 — Strengths & Protective Factors (Ch. 24)

Research-informed markers of well-functioning couples. Check those present:

- ☐ Fondness and admiration for each other
- ☐ Friendship / knowing each other's world
- ☐ Turning toward (not away from) bids for connection
- ☐ Ability to repair after conflict
- ☐ Shared meaning / goals / values
- ☐ More positive than negative interactions
- ☐ Humor and play
- ☐ Mutual respect
- ☐ Commitment to the relationship
- ☐ External support (friends, family, community)

Notable strengths to build on: _____

Domain 8 — Context: Culture, Gender, Spirituality, Economics

- Cultural/ethnic factors shaping expectations: _____
- Gendered role expectations and fairness: _____
- Spiritual/religious values (shared or divergent): _____
- Socioeconomic stress level (0–10): A ____ B ____

Domain 9 — Risk & Safety (summary from Worksheet 01/02)

- Violence / aggression risk: ☐ None ☐ Low ☐ Moderate ☐ High
- Substance risk: ☐ None ☐ Low ☐ Moderate ☐ High
- Self-harm / crisis risk: ☐ None ☐ Low ☐ Moderate ☐ High
- Active affair: ☐ Y ☐ N ☐ Suspected

Domain 10 — Motivation & Goals for Change

	Partner A	Partner B
Stage of change (precontemplation–maintenance)		
What they want to be different		
Willing to look at own contribution?		

Assessment Summary (clinician)

- **Primary presenting problem(s):** _____
- **The negative cycle (name it):** _____
- **Each partner's attachment position:** _____
- **Key individual/contextual factors:** _____
- **Strengths to leverage:** _____
- **Risk level & safety plan needed?** _____
- **Recommended approach(es):** _____
- **Suitable for conjoint therapy now?** ☐ Yes ☐ With modifications ☐ No — refer/sequence

Next: Worksheet 12 — First-Session Goals & Expectations (deep dive) and Worksheet 03 — Formulation & Treatment Plan.

Worksheet 12 — First-Session Goals & Expectations (Deep Dive)

Phase 1 — Assessment & Alliance · Session 1 (extended) *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 1 (Setting the Stage), Ch. 2 (PAIRS format), Ch. 3 (nature of marriage/commitment), Ch. 11 (EFT alliance & assessment), Ch. 12 (Solution-Focused exception/scaling/miracle), Ch. 14 (Feminist/Contextual).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** The first session must accomplish many things simultaneously. This worksheet provides a **detailed walk-through of every goal** to ensure nothing is missed and both partners leave with clarity, hope, and buy-in. It is a *companion* to Worksheet 01 — where 01 is the data-gathering form, 12 is the procedural guide for the clinician.
 - **Format:** Use as a session plan. Walk through sections in order; tick them off as you go. Add your clinical notes.
 - **Time management:** Budget time roughly as shown.
-

Goal 1 — Building the Alliance (15-20 min)

What the book says: "Initiating and maintaining a collaborative alliance in which each spouse experiences being sensitively listened to, understood, empathized with, and not blamed is essential." (EFT, Ch. 11)

How to do it:

- ☐ Welcome both partners warmly; normalize nervousness
- ☐ Explain your role: "I'm not a judge — I'm here to help *both* of you"
- ☐ Brief overview of how couples therapy works (active, skills-based, both are expected to work)
- ☐ "What questions or concerns do you have before we begin?"
- ☐ Maintain balance: roughly equal eye contact, time, and curiosity for each

Clinical note: In the first 5 minutes, partners are scanning for "*is this therapist going to side with them?*" Explicit multidirectional partiality reassures: "*I'm on the side of your relationship, not one of you against the other.*"

Goal 2 — Setting the Frame (10 min)

- ☐ Confidentiality and its limits (duty to report, etc.)

- **No-secrets policy:** What happens if one partner discloses something individually? (State your policy: □ No secrets — anything told individually may be brought into conjoint work □ Limited confidentiality — I will encourage but not force disclosure □ Other: _____)
 - Attendance expectation: both partners attend together unless individual sessions are scheduled
 - Session frequency, expected length of treatment, fees/cancellation
 - How to handle crises between sessions
 - Consent form signed □
-

Goal 3 — Understanding the Relationship Story (15–20 min)

Use the prompts from Worksheet 01, Part C. Key information to gather:

- How they met and what attracted them
- Decision to commit
- High points and turning points
- Current life-cycle stage and stressors
- Family-of-origin context (brief; detailed in Worksheet 02 and 13)

Clinician note: Nichols (Ch. 3) stresses that "the first year or so has been identified as the most difficult time of adjustment in marriage" and "manifold needs are expected to be satisfied in marriage" (citing Lewin). Understand the mismatch between expectations and reality.

Goal 4 — Hearing the Presenting Problem (15 min)

- Each partner states their concerns *uninterrupted* (therapist manages the floor)
 - Use the **Presenting Problems Checklist** (Worksheet 10) to ensure breadth
 - Note convergences and divergences in their reports
 - Map the presenting problem to one of Haley's three entry points: □ Individual symptom □ Child's problem □ Direct couples issue
-

Goal 5 — Conducting the Safety Screen (5–10 min)

- Use Worksheet 01, Part B
 - Ask directly about violence, fear, substance use, and acute risk
 - If flags arise, document and modify plan immediately (see Worksheet 07)
 - *Do not skip this — violence is often undisclosed in conjoint sessions*
-

Goal 6 — Observing the Cycle (continuous throughout)

You don't interpret this aloud yet — you observe and note for the formulation (Worksheet 03).

What to observe:

- Who speaks first? Who defers?
 - What happens when one raises a complaint? (Does the other defend, withdraw, counterattack, placate?)
 - Nonverbal: eye contact, body orientation, sighing, eye-rolling, touching, pulling away
 - Satir styles (Worksheet 04): who placates, blames, distracts, computes, or levels?
 - Emotional temperature: who is hot/flooding, who is shut down?
-

Goal 7 — Instilling Hope (5 min)

Why it matters: Couples come in demoralized. Naming strengths and normalizing struggle gives them a reason to return.

- Name at least one specific strength you observed: *"I notice that even with all the pain, you both showed up. That says something about your commitment."*
 - Normalize: *"Many couples face exactly these kinds of struggles. They're addressable."*
 - Briefly preview: *"In the next sessions we'll understand the pattern and build specific tools."*
-

Goal 8 — Setting Preliminary Goals & Expectations (5–10 min)

- "If therapy goes well, what would be different?" (each partner answers)
 - Scaling: "On a 0–10, where's the relationship now?" (each answers)
 - "What would one point higher look like?"
 - Set realistic expectations: "This takes active work — from both of you, between sessions too."
 - Clarify: this is a first pass; full goals come after assessment (Worksheet 03)
-

Goal 9 — Closing & Next Steps (5 min)

- Summarize briefly what you heard (show you listened)
 - Schedule individual sessions (Worksheet 02, 13)
 - Assign small homework from Worksheet 15 (e.g., notice one positive thing daily)
 - Check in: "How was this for each of you?"
 - Session rating (Worksheet 15)
-

Post-Session Clinician Reflection

- What worked well in this session? _____
- What do I need to adjust for next time? _____
- Initial hypotheses about the cycle: _____
- Any concerns about alliance or safety? _____

Next: Worksheet 02 (Individual histories), Worksheet 13 (Genogram), Worksheet 10 (Problems checklist if not done), Worksheet 11 (Assessment battery).

Worksheet 13 — Genogram & Family-of-Origin Assessment

Phase 1 — Assessment • Individual Sessions (2–3) *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 7 (Bowen Family Systems: multigenerational transmission, differentiation, triangles, cutoffs), Ch. 2 (PAIRS individual histories: family conditioning, models from the parental marriage), Ch. 9 (Object Relations: internalized models).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** Map each partner's multigenerational family patterns. Bowen theory (Ch. 7) holds that couple dynamics are shaped by patterns transmitted across generations — differentiation levels, triangles, emotional cutoffs, and the model of the parental marriage. The PAIRS chapter similarly gathers "family conditioning, early beginnings, models from the parental marriage."
- **Format:** Complete in **individual sessions**, one per partner. Draw the genogram together with the partner on paper/whiteboard, then explore the patterns.
- **Why it helps the couple:** Partners often repeat or react against what they learned at home. Seeing the pattern reduces blame ("this is a pattern I inherited, not a character flaw") and opens change.

Part A — Draw the Genogram

Use standard genogram symbols. Sketch at least **three generations** (the partner, their parents, their grandparents) plus the partner's own children if any.

Legend: □ male □ female □—□ marriage □□□ divorce
 □□□ close/fused □□□ conflictual ---- distant || cutoff

Grandparents: □□□□□□ □□□□□□
 □ □

Parents: □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (quality of marriage: _____)
 □

This partner: □□□□□□ siblings □□□
 [partner]
 □

Children: □ □

(Draw the actual genogram on a separate sheet or whiteboard and attach/photograph for the file.)

Part B — The Parental Marriage (the model you absorbed)

1. How would you describe your parents'/caregivers' relationship? _____
 2. How did they handle conflict? (avoided · yelled · cold war · worked it out · violence)

 3. How was affection shown? _____
 4. Who held the power? How were decisions made? _____
 5. What did you decide, growing up, about what you wanted — or didn't want — in your own relationship? _____
 6. In what ways is your current relationship similar to your parents'? Different?

-

Part C — Your Position in the Family

1. Birth order / sibling position: _____
 2. Role you played in the family (peacemaker, hero, scapegoat, caretaker, invisible one, rebel):

 3. Who were you closest to? Most in conflict with? _____
 4. Family rules — spoken and unspoken: ("We don't talk about...", "You must always...")

 5. Invisible loyalties (expectations you feel bound to honor): _____
-

Part D — Bowen Patterns

Triangles

When tension rose between two people in your family, who got pulled in to stabilize it? (e.g., a child drawn into parental conflict) _____

Are you repeating a triangle now? (e.g., pulling in a child, a parent, a friend, work, an affair, a substance) _____

Emotional Cutoff

Is anyone in your family cut off / estranged? _____ How does your family handle unresolved tension — engage or cut off? _____

Differentiation of Self

- When your family is anxious, do you get swept into it or can you stay calm and connected?

- Can you hold a different opinion from your family without either giving in or cutting off?

Multigenerational Themes

Patterns repeating across generations (divorce, addiction, abuse, over-functioning/under-functioning, affairs, enmeshment, distance):

Part E — Attachment & Early Experience (links to Worksheet 02)

1. As a child, when upset, who soothed you and how? _____
2. Did you feel secure, or did you learn to rely only on yourself / to cling? _____
3. How does that early pattern show up with your partner today? _____

Part F — Clinician Synthesis

- This partner's level of differentiation: low / moderate / high
- Key multigenerational patterns being replayed: _____
- Triangles active in the current relationship: _____
- How family-of-origin shapes this partner's role in the couple's cycle:

- Strengths carried from family of origin: _____

Bringing it to the couple

In the joint feedback session (Worksheet 03), help each partner see:

- "The way you each react in conflict makes sense given where you came from."
- How the two family systems/patterns **collide or combine** to create the couple's cycle.
- This reframes blame into understanding — a key non-blaming move the book emphasizes throughout.

Next: Complete for both partners; integrate into Worksheet 03 (Formulation) and Worksheet 11 (Assessment summary).

Worksheet 14 — Session-by-Session Treatment Map

Phase 2–6 — Treatment Planning & Tracking *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 1 (the arc of treatment), Ch. 11 (EFT nine steps / three stages), Ch. 8 (CBCT treatment plan), Ch. 12 (Solution-Focused), Ch. 2 (PAIRS curriculum format).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** A single-page overview that maps every session to its phase, goal, worksheets, and techniques — so you always know where you are in the treatment arc. Fill in actual dates and notes as therapy proceeds.
 - **Format:** Clinician planning tool. Review before each session; update after.
 - **Flexibility:** The *Handbook* does not prescribe a rigid session count. This map shows a typical 16-session course. Compress (brief/solution-focused) or extend (EFT, object-relations, complex issues) as needed. Sessions can be reordered when special issues or crises arise.
-

The Treatment Arc

Stage 1 — Assessment, Alliance & De-escalation (Sessions 1–5)

Session	Date	Phase	Goals for this session	Worksheets used	Techniques	Notes
1		Alliance + intake + safety	Build alliance; hear the story; safety screen; first-pass goals; set the frame	01, 10, 12, 15	Joining, active listening, multidirectional partiality	
2		Individual A	Family of origin, attachment, expectations, private safety screen	02, 13	Genogram, empathic inquiry	
3		Individual B	Same as above for Partner B	02, 13	Genogram, empathic inquiry	
4		Formulation + goals	Feed back the cycle map; agree on goals; set treatment plan	03, 11, 14	Cycle map drawing, miracle question, scaling	
5		De-escalation	Teach time-out, I-messages, speaker-listener; identify communication styles	04	In-session enactment coaching	

Stage 2 — Restructuring the Bond (Sessions 6–12)

Session	Date	Phase	Goals for this session	Worksheets used	Techniques	Notes
6		Communication	Deepen speaker–listener; Love Knots; complain without blame	04	Enactments, PAIRS Dialogue Guide	
7		Cognitive restructuring	Thought records; attribution checks; identify relationship beliefs	06	CBCT thought records	
8		Emotion work	Access primary emotions beneath the cycle; attachment needs	05	EFT reflection, evocative responding	
9		Emotion work	Enactments — turn to partner with vulnerability; begin withdrawer re-engagement / pursuer softening	05	EFT Steps 5–7 enactments	
10		Problem-solving	Structured problem-solving on a concrete issue; caring days	06	CBCT behavior exchange, caring days	

Session	Date	Phase	Goals for this session	Worksheets used	Techniques	Notes
11		Special issue (if needed)	Address specific module: infidelity / aggression / addiction / illness / other	07	Module-specific interventions	
12		Deepening	Attachment injury repair (if indicated); bonding rituals	05	EFT injury repair steps	

Stage 3 — Consolidation & Termination (Sessions 13–16)

Session	Date	Phase	Goals for this session	Worksheets used	Techniques	Notes
13		Generalize	Apply skills to new situations; "exception" analysis; acceptance vs. change	06	Solution-focused exceptions, ACT	
14		Consolidate	Review goals; practice recovery from old cycle; bonding rituals	08, 05	New narrative of the relationship	
15		Relapse prevention	Write relapse-prevention plan; early-warning signs; toolkit summary	08	Anticipate future stressors	
16		Termination	Appreciation letters; progress review; ending; leave the door open	08, 15	Celebration and closing	

EFT Nine Steps Mapped to Sessions (reference)

EFT Step	Description	Typical sessions
Step 1	Assessment — alliance, cycle identification, attachment	Sessions 1–4
Step 2	Identify the negative interactional cycle	Sessions 4–5
Step 3	Access primary / unacknowledged emotions	Sessions 5–7
Step 4	Reframe the problem as the cycle + attachment needs	Sessions 4–6
Step 5	Promote identification of disowned attachment needs/fears	Sessions 8–10
Step 6	Promote acceptance of partner's emerging experience	Sessions 9–11
Step 7	Facilitate expression of needs/wants; bonding events	Sessions 10–12
Step 8	Facilitate new solutions to old problems	Sessions 13–14
Step 9	Consolidate new positions and cycles	Sessions 14–16

Session Log (cumulative tracking)

After each session, record one line:

Session	Date	Actual focus	Key intervention	Homework assigned	Outcome / shift noted
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					
16					

Use with: Worksheet 15 (per-session rating) every session.

Worksheet 15 — Weekly Session Tracking & Homework Log

Ongoing · Every Session *Source basis: Harway (Ed.), Handbook of Couples Therapy — Ch. 8 (CBCT between-session practice), Ch. 12 (solution-focused scaling), Ch. 2 (PAIRS exercises & practice between sessions), Ch. 24 (process tracking).*

How to use this worksheet (clinician instructions)

- **Purpose:** Keep a continuous record of session-by-session progress and between-session practice. The *Handbook's* skills-based chapters (CBCT, PAIRS) depend on practice between sessions; the solution-focused chapter uses scaling to track movement.
- **Format:** Photocopy/duplicate the tracking table for each session. Review the previous week's homework at the **start** of each session; assign new homework at the **end**.
- **Why it matters:** Reviewing homework communicates that the real work happens between sessions, reinforces accountability, and gives you process data to adjust the plan.
- **Keep both:** a per-session rating (quick scale) and a homework log.

A — Per-Session Rating (complete each session)

Duplicate this block for every session.

Session #: ____ **Date:** _____

Rating (0–10)	Partner A	Partner B
How is the relationship this week?		
How connected did you feel this week?		
How well did we use our new skills?		
How safe/respected did you feel?		
Hope for the relationship		

What went well this week: _____

What was hard this week: _____

Clinician observations (cycle present/absent, skills used, affect):

Focus of today's session: _____

B — Homework Review (start of session)

Homework assigned last week	Did you do it?	How did it go?	Barriers
	☐ Y ☐ Partial ☐ N		
	☐ Y ☐ Partial ☐ N		
	☐ Y ☐ Partial ☐ N		

If homework wasn't done, explore barriers non-judgmentally and adjust (make it smaller, clearer, or address resistance) rather than scolding.

C — Homework Assigned (end of session)

New homework	Who does it	By when
	☐ A ☐ B ☐ Both	
	☐ A ☐ B ☐ Both	
	☐ A ☐ B ☐ Both	

D — Homework Menu (pick from these by phase)

Phase 1-2 (Assessment/Formulation):

- Each partner notices and records one thing they appreciate about the other daily
- Observe (don't change) when the negative cycle shows up; note the trigger

Phase 3 (Communication/De-escalation):

- Daily 15-min Speaker-Listener check-in on a positive topic (Worksheet 04)
- Convert 3 blame-thoughts into I-messages
- Practice the agreed Time-Out once if reactivity rises

Phase 4 (Restructuring):

- One "vulnerability conversation" using the enactment script (Worksheet 05)

- Each partner performs □ ____ caring behaviors/day from partner's list (Worksheet 06)
- Complete 2 thought records (Worksheet 06)
- Daily bonding ritual (20-sec hug, check-in, gratitude)

Phase 5 (Special issues):

- Module-specific practice (e.g., transparency check-ins for infidelity; trigger log for trauma; relapse-prevention steps for addiction)

Phase 6 (Consolidation):

- Practice recovering from the cycle on your own and report back
- Implement the sustaining rituals from Worksheet 08

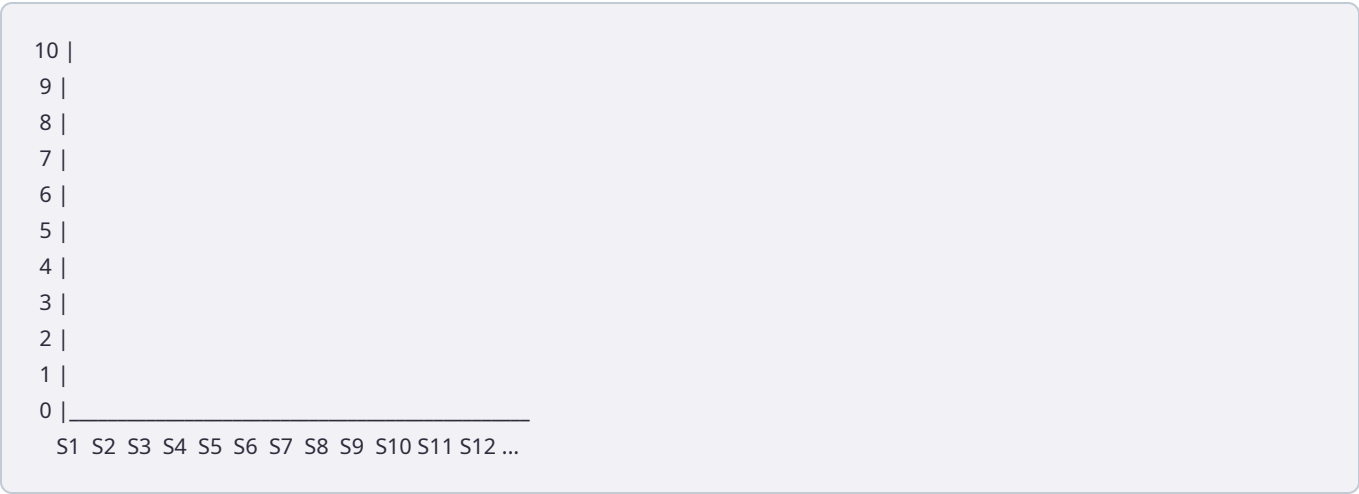
E — Positives Tracker (ongoing — Gottman-informed / CBCT)

Research across the *Handbook* emphasizes the ratio of positive to negative interactions. Have the couple log positives to counteract negativity bias.

Date	Positive interaction / appreciation noticed	Who initiated

F — Overall Progress Graph (optional)

Plot the "How is the relationship this week?" scaling score (0–10) across sessions to visualize the trajectory:



Use the graph in the termination review (Worksheet 08) to show the couple their progress concretely.